

Pregnancy dating

2026-07-19

- Our aim when dating a pregnancy is
 - to get the **EDD** (expected date of delivery)
 - Menstrual dating: getting the EDD from LMP
 - Ultrasound dating: getting EDD from US using fetal biometry
 - to calculate the current **GA** (conveniently from EDD, for easy comparison with US regardless of its GA)
- Are there different types of “ages” for a pregnancy?
 - Menstrual age = **GA**: from the LMP
 - Conception age: from fertilization = menstrual – 2 weeks
 - Implantation age: from implantation = menstrual – 3 weeks
- What is the EDD?
 - When calculating GA from an average 28-day cycle, EDD = 280 days (40 weeks) after LMP
 - For cycles longer than 28 days: add the difference from 28
 - For cycles shorter than 28 days: subtract the difference from 28
 - To get the EDD from the LMP (the 280 d = 40 w), we apply **Naegele rule**:

$$EDD = LMP + 7d - 3m + 1y$$

Tip: if $LMP < \text{April} \rightarrow EDD = LMP + 7d + 9m$

- Menstrual dating should be confirmed with US dating before 20 weeks.
Otherwise, this pregnancy is *suboptimally dated*.
 - EDD can be reassigned only once (if any) if the discrepancy threshold is met, according to the GA at US.
 - ACOG table

			1		14	21	28	...	280
-2	cy-	-1 cycle	LMP		Ovula-		Missed		EDD
cles					tion		period		
					Fertil-	Implan-			
					ization	tation			